12

CONSTRUCTION SKILLS

12.1 INTRODUCTION

The art of stitching is a combination of many skills. Many processes are used in constructing a garment and giving it its final form. The same process cannot be used in making all garments - different processes are used for different garments, such as facing, binding, zips, etc. If one does not have adequate knowledge of all these processes one will not be able to make garments of various types and designs. Hence, one needs to have knowledge of the various processes involved like collars, designing, etc. Let us find out more about these in this lesson.

12.2 OBJECTIVES

After reading this lesson, you will be able to :

- demonstrate the use of facings;
- attach a collar;
- design and use different types of yokes;
- use elastics in garments;
- attach zips;
- explain midrifts;
- demonstrate the use of different bindings.

12.3 FACING

The cloth used to bind the raw edges of upper garments by folding inwards, is called facing.

12.4 TYPES OF FACING

Necklines are generally finished with a facing. Facings are suitable for thick fabrics. They are generally done by two methods, which are as follows -

1. A bias strip can be used for the facing but this is generally done when a narrow facing is to be done. The bias trip is cut ½" wide and is stitched along the edge of the neckline or the armhole. While stitching, care should be taken not to stretch the bias strip. This gives a good finishing without pulling the neckline out of shape. After stitching along the edge, the bias strip is turned inside towards the wrong side of the garment. It is then folded in and hemmed into place.

2. For a wider facing, a strip cut in the shape of the neckline is used. The right side of the garment is placed over a piece of cloth and a running stitch is made along the neckline. After this, the neckline is stitched into place. After stitching, the cloth is cut along the neckline. The cloth is also cut in the same shape on the other side leaving a margin of 1½" to 2". This strip is then turned over and is either hemmed or stitched to give a neat edge. Sometimes a very wide strip maybe used and in that case, the shaped strip is simply turned in and stitched along the edge from the front so that it does not show. In this way a facing can be used to finish the raw edge of necklines, etc.

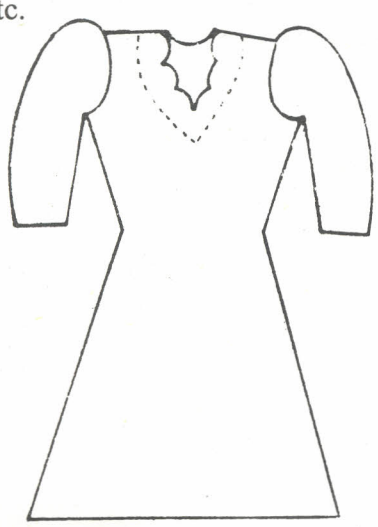


Fig 12.1

12.5 BINDING

The rolled edge formed after attaching a bias strip to a raw edge is called a binding. The

bias strip may be bought ready made from the market or can be made by cutting bias strips and joining them.

12.6 TYPES OF BINDING

Piping is of different types such as:-

1) Bias piping

The piping made by attaching bias strips is known as bias piping. To make this, a square piece of cloth is folded at an angle of 45° and cut into strips. The bias strip is stretched while attaching and then folded to give a thin rolled edge and hemmed into place. The thinner the rolled edge, the better the piping looks.

2) Corded piping

When a cord is used along with the piping, it is known as corded piping. Corded piping is very strong. It is used on the edges of a cushion. It gives a very attractive look as it is raised from the surface.

3) Rolle piping

This is used to make loops or put cord, etc in suits. To make this, a uniform bias strip of ¾" to 1" width is taken. It is folded in half (widthwise) with right sides facing and stitched about 1½ pt. in from the edge. A long, double threaded needle is then passed inside the stitched part, after securing one side and the entire strip is turned inside out. It then resembles a cord. This is known as a rolle piping.

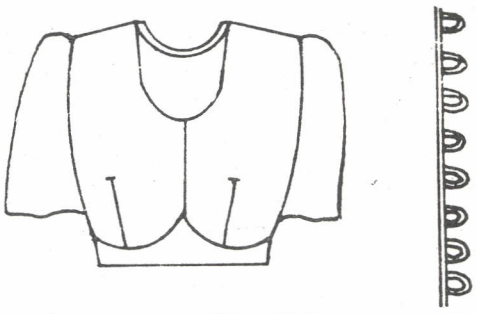


Fig 12.2

12.7 ZIP

A zip is used to close two open edges of a garment. Zips are available in various sizes and are of various types, like -

1. Brass zip

2. Steel zip

3. Plastic/nylon zip

First of all, the edges where the zip is to be attached, have to be made secure. The zip should be placed parallel, under the edge. It should always be closed while attaching. It is better to baste the zip in place so that there is no puckering or stretching of the cloth. It is finally stitched on three sides.

Zips are used in bags, purses, pants, frocks, jackets, suits, skirts, etc. The zip used should be of the same colour as that of the cloth.

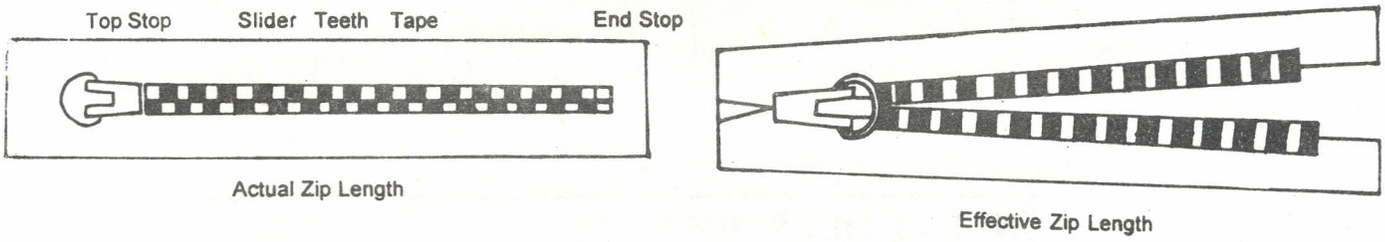


Fig 12.3

12.8 ELASTIC

Elastic are of various kinds like - round, flat, narrow, wide, etc. They are used in different garments. The method of using elastic is different in different garments such as in pyjama bottoms, in pyjama belt or in skirts and knickers.

In pyjama belt, the elastic used is 2 points wide. It is inserted with the help of a safety pin. The two edges are drawn up and placed on top of each other and stitched securely. Care must be taken to see that the elastic does not twist while threading otherwise it will hurt the wearer.

A broader elastic is used in knickers. The cloth left for the belt is turned to the right side. The elastic is placed on top and is stitched first at the top and then the bottom edge. The cloth is then turned over and stitched in place. Parallel rows of stitching is then made on the elastic belt which serve two purposes - one, the elastic does not twist at any point and two, the slight pleats which appear look attractive.

When attaching elastic on the bottom of sleeves or pyjamas, the elastic is placed about 1" inside the edge and stretched and stitched into place. This results in small pleats which make a small frill at the edge. Round elastic can also be used in pyjamas.

In this way, elastics are used different garments.

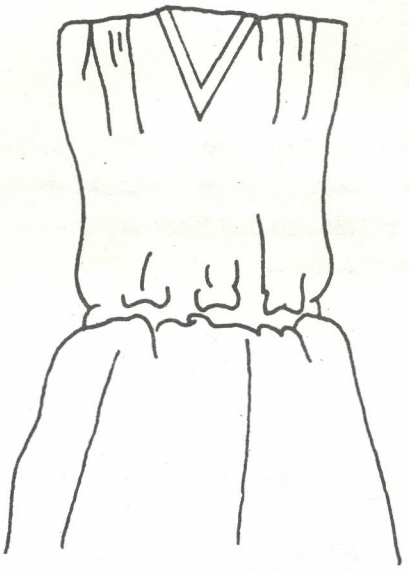


Fig 12.4

INTEXT QUESTIONS 12.1

State whether the following statements are true or false.

1. Round elastic is used in pyjamas.
2. Zip should be kept open while attaching.
3. The bias strip should not be stretched while attaching.
4. A wide facing should be cut in the shape of the neckline.
5. Elastics are attached in a similar manner in all garments.

12.9 DESIGN DART

Darts are used to either give fullness or close fitting according to the figure of the person. Darts can be made in different ways - by cutting the cloth and then stitching it or by diagonally stitching the excess cloth at the place fullness is desired.

Dart

The diagonal line of stitching given on a fold of cloth which is broad at one end and tapering to one or both ends, is known as dart. Darts give fullness to the heavier parts of the body. Darts are mainly of two types -

i) Single point dart

The single point dart is used in skirts, blouses, vests, etc. It is broad at one end and pointed at the other.

ii) Double point dart

The double point dart is pointed at both ends. It is generally used in ladies suit. Darts are placed at different places in different garments. They derive their name according to their placements, such as -

i)	Waist dart	ii)	Side dart
iii)	Armhole dart	iv)	Center front dart
v)	Shoulder dart	vi)	Hip dart
vii)	Elbow dart	viii)	Neck dart

Rules for making darts

In order to make neat darts, the following rules must be followed.

1. While making darts, the beginning and the end of the seam should be made doubly secure.
2. If the dart is very wide at one end, flatten the dart from the center while attaching to another piece.
3. The width of a double point dart at the center should be 1 to 1½ cms.
4. In thick fabrics, the dart is cut from the center and the cloth spread on both sides or pressed open.

There are some other darts used in dress making which are conventionally not called darts, such as french dart, panel dart, fish dart, etc.

French dart

The french dart is made in ladies kurta from the bust point to small hip. [Fig 12.5 (a)]

Fist dart

This dart is used while joining the bodice to the sleeve. It is shaped like a fish hence it is called a fish dart. [Fig 12.5 (b)]

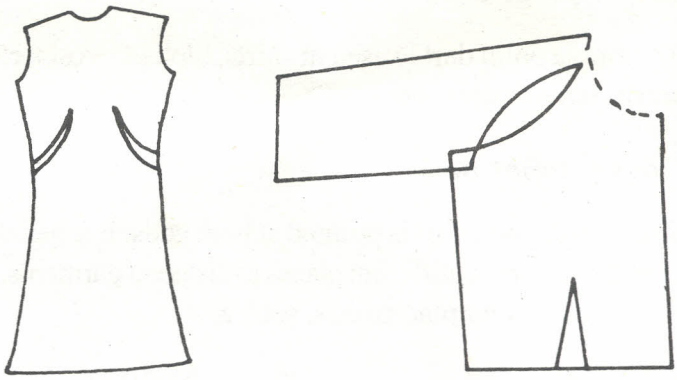


Fig 12.5 (a) French dart (b) Fish dart.

Panel dart

To make this dart, the entire length of cloth which would be folded inside the dart, is cut away and the two edges stitched together to give fitting to the garment. It is used in smart fitting petticoats. It is also used in jackets, coats, etc. The dart is not visible either from the right or from the wrong side of the garment as the dart is made by removing the cloth of the dart and joining the two sides. In this way, different darts are made.

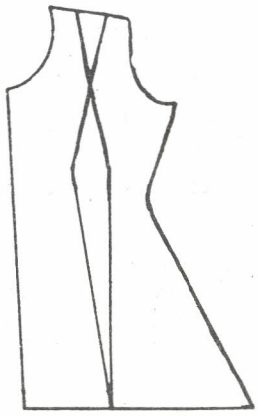


Fig 12.6 Panel dart

12.10 YOKE AND MIDRIFT

YOKE

The piece of cloth attached to the upper part of a garment is called a yoke. It may be of the same cloth as the garment or it may be different.

Need for yoke

1. To increase the strength of the garment.
2. To change the direction of the cloth to prevent stretching.
3. To make a fashionable design.
4. To balance the weight of the dress.

Yoke is generally used in the upper body garments. Sometimes may also be used in lower body garments. Yoke are used in the following places -

1. Shoulders of shirts
2. Front and back of ladies garments.
3. Below the belt in skirts - front and back.
4. Waist line of maxi.
5. Back or hip of heavy garments like jeans. It is difficult to make darts in jeans hence a yoke is used for fitting.
6. One piece front and back yoke for design.

Yoke are sometimes made of double layer cloth but is made of single layer only in thick fabrics. The place where a yoke is attached should be made secure with double row stitching.

Yoke may sometimes be used to increase the length of the garment or may be made in a contrasting cloth to create interesting designs.

Yoke is generally cut on the cross grain and is often used at the back of men's shirt and in jeans. The width of the yoke varies with fashion. When we need a flaired skirt but a fitted waist, we make use of a yoke. In this way a yoke can be used variously in different garments.

Yoke can be made in many different shapes such as -

i) Round yoke ii) B yoke

iii) Square yoke iv) Straight yoke

v) Peak pointed yoke

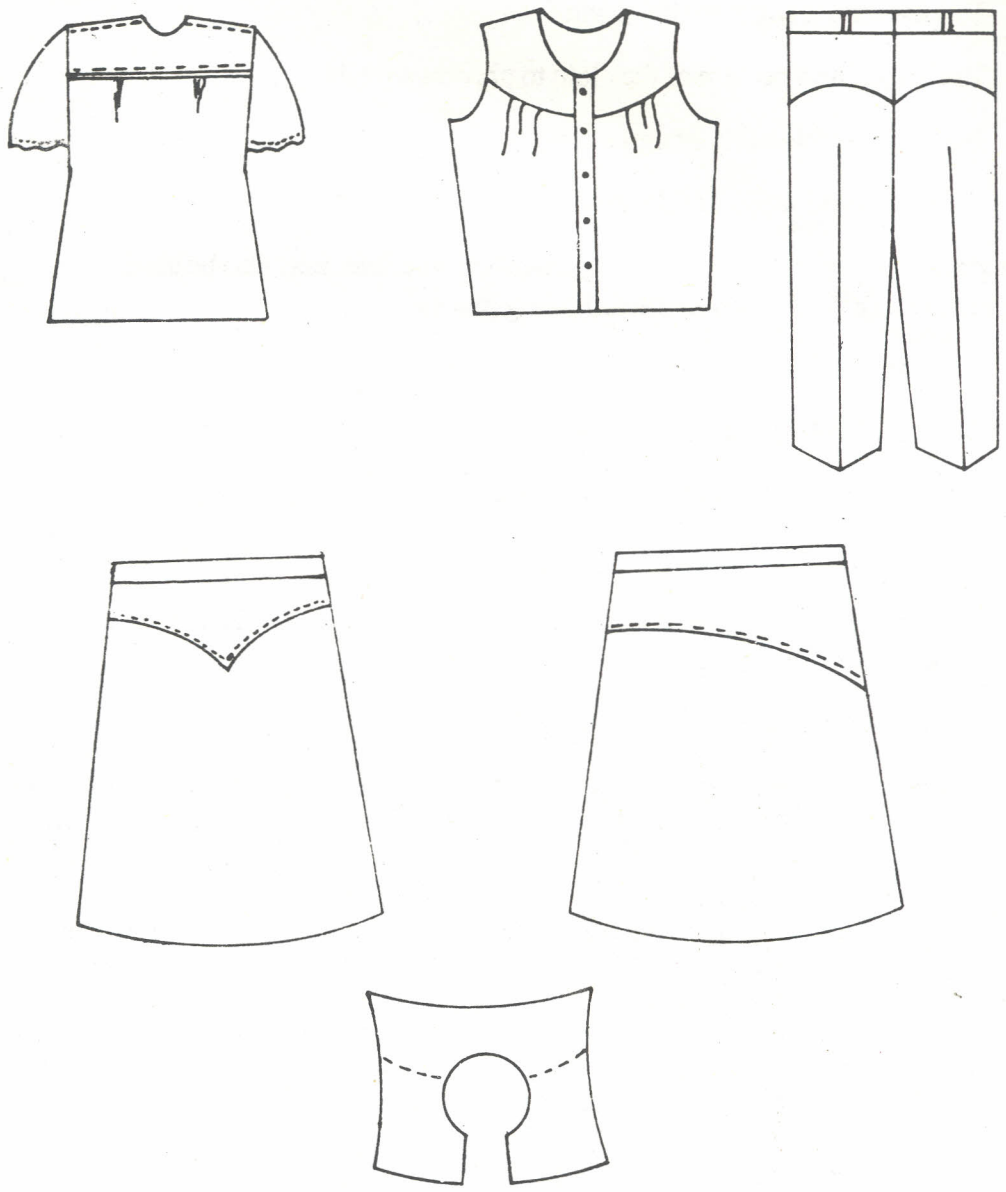


Fig 12.7 Different types of yokes.

MIDRIFT

The design or pleat used in the middle/center of any garment is known as midrift. The cloth pleated at the back, under the yoke, in men's shirts, is a midrift. In effect, it is a device used to adjust the cloth of the back of a shirt to the yoke piece. Since loose fitting shirts are preferred these days, a pleat is made at the back. This adds to the beauty of the shirt as well. The midrift is also used as a design in ladies suit. Two types of pleats are used to make a midrift. They are -

1. Box pleat

When two knife pleats are made in opposite direction a box pleat is made. This is used in scouts shirt and in pockets and shirts of military uniform. The cloth is gathered into a pleat from the wrong side and stitched into place. The pleats are then pressed open and stitched along the pressed edges. It has the appearance of a box.

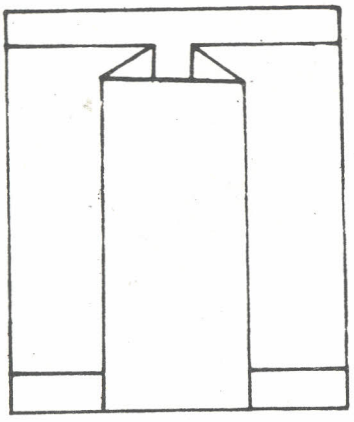


Fig 12.8 Box pleat

2. Inverted pleat

When two pleats facing each other are stitched together, it is called an inverted pleat. The reverse of a box pleat is an inverted pleat. It is used in gents shirts, in skirts and in other garments to make them attractive.

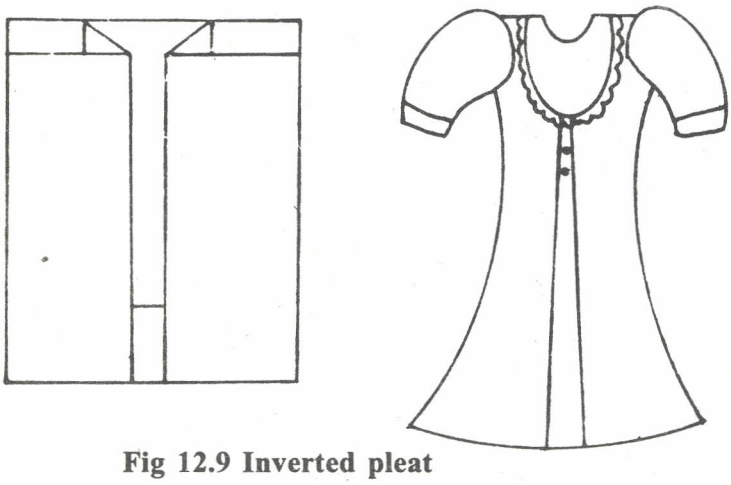


Fig 12.9 Inverted pleat

12.11 BELT

A belt is used to make a fitted waist. It is used in pants, knickers, skirts, etc. Belts are of two types and are used in two ways. These are -

1. Frock belt

A frock is generally made quite loose for children and a belt is used to tighten it slightly at the waist. It is attached to the yoke which is generally a plain yoke. A belt is similarly used in house coats but the belt used is straight and is not fixed. The belt of a frock is cut on a bias. It is stitched along two edges by keeping right sides facing and then turned inside out. It is properly pressed and is then attached to the sides of the bodice.

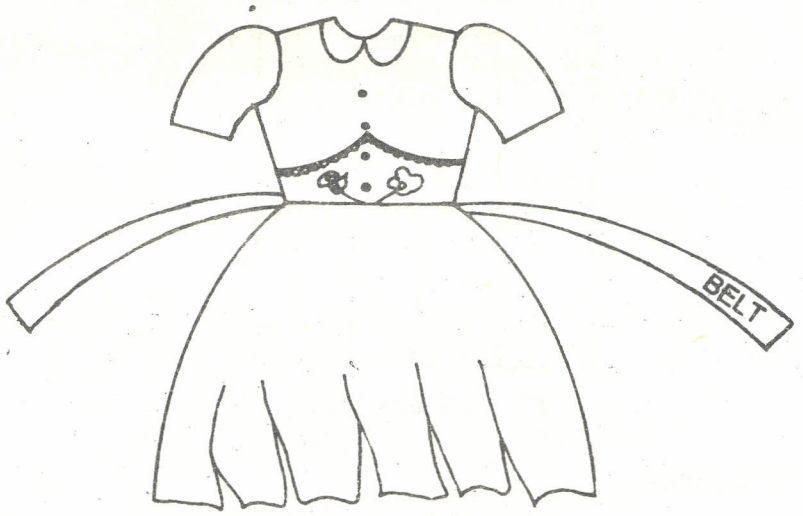


Fig 12.10 Frock belt.

2. Pant, knicker, skirt belt

The belt is fixed in a different manner in pants, knickers and skirts. The belt is prepared by cutting 1½" wide buckram and 2" wide piece of cloth and placing them altogether with a piece of lining. Leaving the lining, the belt is attached to the waist from the right side. The belt is then turned over, pressed and stitched from the right side. In this way, the belt is ready.

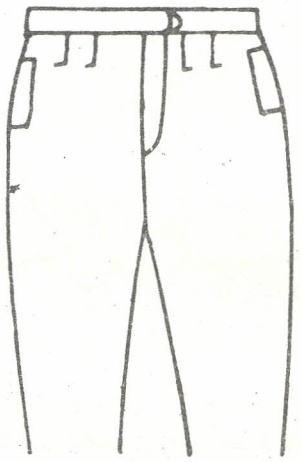


Fig. 12.11 Pant belt

12.12 NOTCH COLLAR - ROLL COLLAR

In this collar half the collar stands up and the other halfturns and rolls over. The stand and the fall can be made separately too. A one piece collar is made as an open collar. This type of collar is made in shirts, bushirts, shirts of safari suits etc.

In garments like gowns, the collar is cut as a part of the front piece. The lapel is made by keeping extra cloth beyond the center front line. The lining which is used in such a collar is of the same cloth as the garment. In garments like coat and gown, the line at which the collar folds and falls back on the garment is known as the lapel break line. The lapel is folded and stitched. A tape or braid can be used on the fold to prevent spreading or flattening.

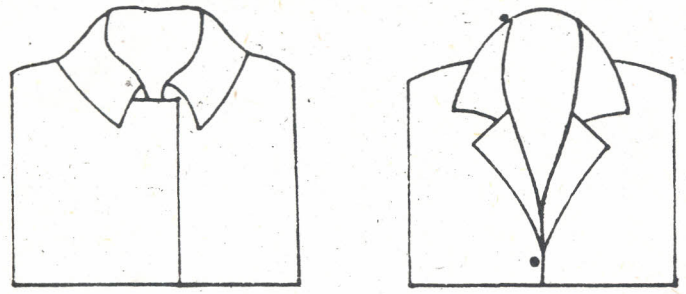


Fig 12.12 (a) Roll collar (b) Notch collar

12.13 WHAT YOU HAVE LEARNT

In this lesson you have learnt about the types of facings and bindings, how to attach zips and elastics, how to make darts, yokes, midrift, notch and roll collar and how to make and attach belts.

12.14 TERMINAL EXERCISE

1. Describe the various types of bindings. How and where are they used?
2. Distinguish between :
   - i) Facing and binding
   - ii) Yoke and midrift

12.15 ANSWERS TO INTEXT QUESTIONS

i) True

ii) False

iii) False

iv) True

v) False